

GOSPEL FOUNDATIONS | BOOKLET 1

How to Be Saved

A Clear Invitation to Life in Christ

FIREPROOF STUDIES

Deep Truth. Biblical Roots. Kingdom Focus.

A Question That Matters

What does God require of me? Can my sins be forgiven? What happens when I die? Can I really know God?

The Bible does not answer those questions by giving us a technique for becoming religious or a list of good deeds to perform. It brings us to Jesus Christ.

To be saved is not merely to escape a future punishment. It is to be brought out of a life ruled by self and into the life of Jesus Christ.

You Were Made for Life with God

God made you. You are not an accident, nor do you belong finally to yourself. He made human beings in His image and gave us a place in His world under His good rule.

Your life is a gift received from Him. Every breath, ability, relationship, joy, and good thing comes from the God who made you. But He made you for more than survival, achievement, or momentary happiness.

True life is fellowship with God: knowing Him, receiving His love, living under His wise authority, and becoming what He created you to be.

"And this is life eternal, that they might know thee the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom thou hast sent." - John 17:3

We Have Turned from God

The Bible calls our turning from God sin. Sin includes the things we do that God forbids, but it goes deeper than a list of wrong actions. Sin is self-rule. It is the claim that we have the right to decide what is good, direct our own lives, and use God's gifts without yielding to God Himself.

We see this in the world around us, but we must also see it in ourselves. We have all chosen our own way. We have loved created things more than the Creator. We have ignored His Word when it opposed our desires.

Sin separates us from the God who is the source of life. It leaves us guilty before Him, unable to repair ourselves, and moving toward death. Good deeds cannot erase guilt already incurred. We need more than advice. We need rescue.

"For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God." - Romans 3:23

God Has Acted in Jesus Christ

The good news is that God has not left us in our rebellion.

Jesus Christ is God's eternal Son, who became man. He entered our world of weakness, sorrow, temptation, suffering, and death. Yet He did not repeat our rebellion. He lived in perfect obedience to the Father, fully revealing what faithful human life was meant to be.

Then He died. Jesus did not die merely as an example of courage or love. He died for our sins. At the cross, the innocent Son gave Himself for guilty sinners. He bore what we could not bear and opened the way of forgiveness and peace with God.

"Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures; And that he was buried." - 1 Corinthians 15:3-4

The Risen Savior

Jesus did not remain in the grave. He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures. His resurrection declares that death has not conquered Him. He lives, and He is able to give life to those who come to Him.

This is the gospel: God has acted in His Son. Jesus Christ died for sinners and rose again. He is not merely someone to admire from a distance. He is the Savior to whom you are called to come, and He is the Lord before whom every life must finally bow.

*"He rose again the third day according to the scriptures." - 1
Corinthians 15:4*

Come to Christ: Turn and Trust

Because God has acted in Christ, He now calls you to respond.

Repentance and faith are not two religious tasks to complete. They are one turn. Repentance means turning from sin and self-rule. It means giving up the claim that you are your own final authority.

Faith means turning to Jesus Christ in trusting surrender. It is more than agreeing that the gospel is true. A person may understand the message, feel its force, or even admire Jesus while still holding his own life back from Christ.

"Repent ye, and believe the gospel." - Mark 1:15

Trust Christ Himself

Saving faith says, 'I give myself to Jesus Christ. I will no longer trust myself to save or rule me. I place my guilt, my future, and my whole life in His hands.'

This is not a work by which you earn salvation. You cannot save yourself by trying harder to believe, by becoming better first, or by offering God a list of promises. Salvation is God's gift. Yet He calls you to receive His Son truly - not merely His benefits, but Christ Himself.

To receive Christ as Savior is to receive Him as Lord. There are not two different Jesuses: one who rescues you from judgment and another whose authority you may consider later. The Jesus who saves is Lord.

"But as many as received him, to them gave he power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on his name." - John 1:12

What God Gives When You Trust Christ

When you turn from self-rule and entrust yourself to Christ, God does more than change your religious identity. The Holy Spirit joins you to the risen Son and gives you new life.

Jesus called this being born again. It is not merely becoming a more disciplined version of your old self. It is receiving a new life in Christ.

Because you belong to Christ, God forgives your sins. He brings you into peace with Himself. He receives you into His family. He gives you His Spirit, a new identity, and a future that death cannot destroy.

The sinner believes; the Spirit gives life.

"Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new." - 2 Corinthians 5:17

Do Not Put Off the Christ Who Calls You

Perhaps you have understood the gospel before. Perhaps you have felt sorrow over sin, fear about death, or a desire to change your life. Those things matter, but they are not the same as entrusting yourself to Christ.

Do not confuse understanding with surrender. Do not confuse emotion with faith. Do not confuse repeating words with coming to Jesus Himself.

Speak to God plainly. Ask Him for mercy. Tell Him that you are placing your life in the hands of His Son. But do not trust the words you say; trust Christ Himself.

**You do not need to find the right words or repeat a formula.
You need to come honestly to Jesus Christ.**

"Him that cometh to me I will in no wise cast out." - John 6:37

Come to Him

The question is not whether you can make yourself worthy enough to come. You cannot. The question is whether you will continue to rule yourself or come to the Savior who gave Himself for you and rose again.

If someone gave you this booklet, tell that person today: 'I have trusted Christ,' or 'I want to come to Christ and need help taking that step.'

Come to Him.

What Comes Next?

If you have entrusted yourself to Christ, do not try to walk alone.

Tell the Christian who shared this booklet with you, or speak with a faithful pastor or mature believer. Be baptized as Christ commanded. Begin reading God's Word. Gather with a faithful local church where you can learn Christ's teaching, grow in faith, and serve with other believers.

You will have questions. That is not a sign that your faith is unreal. New life grows. The next step is not to earn what Christ has given, but to learn to live in the life you have received from Him.

Read the Bible

Read these passages slowly. Ask God to help you see Christ clearly and respond to Him honestly.

John 1:1-18 | John 3:1-21 | John 6:35-40 | John 10:1-18 | Romans 3:21-28 |
Romans 5:1-11 | Romans 10:8-13 | Ephesians 2:1-10 | 1 Corinthians 15:1-8
| 2 Corinthians 5:14-21

To learn more, visit Fireproof Studies and explore the Gospel, Faith, Repentance, New Birth, Forgiveness, Assurance, and Baptism glossary pages.

A Note for the Christian Sharing This Booklet

Read it with your friend. Let the Scriptures speak. Ask honest questions. Do not pressure a person to repeat words he does not mean.

Point him to Jesus Christ, remain available afterward, and help him take his first steps as a disciple.

The next Gospel Foundations booklet is *What Happens After I Trust Christ?*. The wider *Life in Christ* Resource Cluster will provide a full overview of God's saving work.

Questions to Talk About

What do you understand about Jesus Christ? What do you believe He is calling you to do? What questions remain?

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